

12.1 Radio se MP3 tak

When radio programmes were first broadcast in India, loudspeakers were set up near popular public areas so that people could hear local folk music. At the time, owning a radio set of your own meant you ate caviar for dinner and had four orderlies to take care of your Rolls. But as radio has pervaded boundaries and classes, it has also expanded its horizons. Speaking in the context of music, today there are over 9,000 radio stations in the USA playing every conceivable genre of music. Radio was the reason The Beatles were as big as they were. Music charts were decided on how many people requested for the songs of a particular band. But the power to choose still rested with the people who owned the radio station.

And then came the Gramophone... From the Gramophone, to Audio CDs to buying MP3s online; the point of people being able to purchase music is that they get exactly what they want. Just like cornflakes. What has happened is that we are living in a world where we decide what we want, and that's what we get. So from listening to any random song on the radio, you can choose to listen to whatever you've got on your iPod.

12.2 Walk Man, Walk

Everyone had to have one. Sony's Walkman was the most wanted portable device in almost every country in the world. It actually allowed people to listen to music while walking! The concept of portability exploded on to the world and Nintendo made millions selling their Gameboys. After the Walkman, no portable device really had the 'cult' following that Sony exploited so profitably. Until the iPod. The iPod was and is the only true 'cult' device of our times. But along with the iPod, a casual listener of music has the option of purchasing several portable music devices that suit every budget. And these days, with convergence becoming the keyword for everything so much so that your car can also have a TV in it, portable music is not restricted just to MP3 players. These days, cell phones double up as portable music players as well. In fact, if you've been watching TV recently, you'll notice both Sony Ericsson and Nokia advertising their